

4.7 Troubleshooting: Unsticking a Matrix Field

When you get stuck on a specific field and can't even make a best guess, reach for this prompt. Put it into your AI tool along with any partial matrix data you have. Pick the suggestion that feels right, adjust it slightly, and keep moving forward.

Copy the prompt below into your AI tool. Fill in every bracket before generating.

I am building a Dialogue Matrix for a character in a [GENRE] novel. I am stuck on the [FIELD_NAME, e.g., "Emotional Default"] field. Here is what I have so far:

[PASTE_YOUR_PARTIAL_MATRIX_OR_RELEVANT_PROFILE_DATA]

Based on this information, suggest three possible constraint statements for the [FIELD_NAME] field. Each statement should be specific, measurable, and written in imperative language the AI can execute during dialogue generation.

Selection rule: Notice which suggestion makes your chest feel tight. That physical response tells you it is the right one to choose, so write that suggestion into your matrix. Then move to the next field. If you still feel frozen, return to your Chapter 3 profile and pull one more specific trait from the matching source layer. Your profile provides the raw material, and your matrix is where you translate it. When your translation feels thin, the source material holds the answer.